Ludovico Franco

Curriculum Vitae

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Trumpet player, improviser and PhD researcher in Music Composition and Performance at the Conservatorio Statale di Musica "Luisa D'Annunzio", Pescara (joint programme with the conservatories of Ferrara, Trieste and Udine).

DOCTORAL RESEARCH

since 12/2025 — ***Improvvisare lo Spazio*** (Improvising Space), doctoral research, Conservatorio di Pescara. Supervisor: Laura Zattra; co-supervisor: Matteo Tomasetti.

The project investigates the relationship between musical improvisation and urban sound space, in places marked by acoustic and social complexity.

2026 — **Urban listening and improvisation workshop**, Vicenza, Musica Bacàn residency (19 June). Field recording in the city, shared re-listening and improvisation with six musicians. Reflexive thematic analysis (Braun & Clarke) of a corpus comprising an autoethnographic journal, a focus group, an interview and questionnaires.

2026 — **Open listening lab for the neighbourhood and site-specific performance**, Parco Bergamini, Casal Bruciato (Rome), autumn 2026.

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

2027 — "Zoning acustico. Dispositivi di controllo dello spazio pubblico e pratiche artistiche sonore come metodo di indagine urbanistica" [Acoustic zoning: devices for controlling public space and sound-art practices as a method of urban inquiry], XV Giornata Internazionale di Studio INU, special session "Territori, Città, Innovazione", Naples, 22 January 2027.

2026 — "The Nomadic Ear: Collective Field Recording and Non-Identitarian Listening in Urban Space", in P. Montella (ed.), *SPaMEC 2026: Sound Crossing Communities. Atti della conferenza*, Naples, Materiale Elettrico, pp. 223–226, ISBN 979-12-986646-0-9, doi:10.5281/zenodo.22528123. Paper presented at the conference, Conservatorio "San Pietro a Majella", Naples, 15–16 May 2026.

2026 — "Improvising the City: Collective Field Recording and the Archipelago of Urban Listening", Siena Jazz Symposium *Insular Practices, Archipelagic Networks*, Siena Jazz University, 11–12 May 2026.

EDUCATION

since 12/2025 — PhD in Music Composition and Performance, 41st cycle. Conservatorio "Luisa D'Annunzio", Pescara, joint programme with Ferrara, Trieste and Udine.

2022 — Second-level Academic Diploma (MA equivalent) in Jazz Trumpet, 110/110 cum laude. Thesis: "L'utilizzo dell'elettronica per l'elaborazione di strumenti acustici nella musica improvvisata" [The use of electronics to process acoustic instruments in improvised music]. Siena Jazz University.

2019	First-level University Master's in Sound Engineering (postgraduate). Università di Roma Tor Vergata.
2018	First-level Academic Diploma (BA equivalent) in Jazz Trumpet, 110/110 cum laude. Conservatorio di Frosinone.
2016–17	Erasmus exchange, third year of studies. Codarts, Rotterdam.

DISCOGRAPHY AS LEADER

2025	*How a City Is Made*, Shimmering Moods Records. The building site as a sonic ecosystem in transformation.
2025	*Open Field*, ROHS Records, Lontano Series. Field recordings of a collective performance inspired by James Tenney's *In a Large Open Space*, reworked with electronics.
2025	*La Linea Obliqua*, with Federico D'Angelo, Folderol. Improvisation, extended techniques and the interaction of acoustic sounds with the spaces that host them.
2020	*Rhetorica*, Syrphe, Berlin. Solo trumpet and electronics.

SELECTED ARTISTIC ACTIVITY

2023	Third Musica Bacàn artistic residency (July–September, with OperaEstate), artistic direction by Dan Kinzelman, out of which the quintet Six Memos was formed, inspired by Calvino's *Six Memos for the Next Millennium*. Concerts at Notte della Ricerca (Vicenza), Note in Musica (Cuneo), Opera Estate (Bassano del Grappa).
2023	*Sonic Architecture* by Tobias Koch, in collaboration with Emiliano Maggi, Istituto Svizzero, Rome.
2022–26	Ensemble Tabula Rasa, directed by Stefano Battaglia, produced by the Accademia Chigiana; Teatro dei Rozzi, Siena; album *Materia* (Centripeta, 2026).

PERFORMING

since 2024	Pop: with Elodie (San Siro and Maradona stadiums, Primo Maggio concert in Rome, Arena di Verona), Robbie Williams (X Factor 2024 final), Achille Lauro (Circo Massimo, 2025) and Ketama126.
since 2022	Jazz: with Jemma, first prize and "Best Composition" award at Jazz in the Park, Cluj (2025); Donostiako Jazz Fest, Auditorium Parco della Musica; album on Emme Record Label (2023), produced by Gianluca Petrella.

CURATING

2021–23	Artistic director of Ekstasis, a series of contemporary music concerts held in churches across Rome.